

Postpartum - Vision Loss or Change - Female (Adult)

Algorithm 1429 | Adult (18 years and older) | Gender at birth: Female

Definition

- Postpartum vision change assessment decomposed from NHS.UK's published pre-eclampsia guidance, distinct from the general Vision Loss or Change protocol (batch14).
- Adult patient.
- Female.

Initial assessment

1. [DURATION] How many days/weeks since delivery?
2. [OPEN_TEXT] Describe the vision change.
3. [YES_NO] Any headache, swelling, or pain below the ribs?
4. [YES_NO] If the patient is under 18, can they speak privately now, and do they say they feel safe with the accompanying adult?

Triage and redirect questions

1. Redirect → Vision Loss or Change

Is vision loss or change the primary concern without recent childbirth?

Vision symptoms outside the postpartum period belong in the Vision Loss or Change pathway.

1. Disposition level 100

Is there a new postpartum vision change such as blurred vision, flashing lights, spots, or loss of vision, whether or not headache, upper abdominal pain, swelling, or vomiting is also present?

NHS.UK pre-eclampsia guidance lists vision problems as a key warning sign that can appear in the days or weeks after birth, needing immediate evaluation.

Advice

Emergency postpartum vision change precautions

- Call Qatar emergency services on 999 now. Do not drive yourself. Tell the call handler that the patient gave birth recently. Call Qatar 999 now, follow the call-taker's ambulance and emergency-transport instructions, and do not self-drive. Do not delay emergency care.
- Call Back If: vision worsens; headache worsens.

First aid

- Call Qatar emergency services on 999 now. Do not drive yourself. Tell the call handler that the patient gave birth recently. Call Qatar 999 now, follow the call-taker's ambulance and emergency-transport instructions, and do not self-drive. Do not delay emergency care.

References

- NHS.UK, "Pre-eclampsia", <https://www.nhs.uk/conditions/pre-eclampsia/> (page last reviewed 23 March 2026)
- explicitly covers postpartum onset

Provenance

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